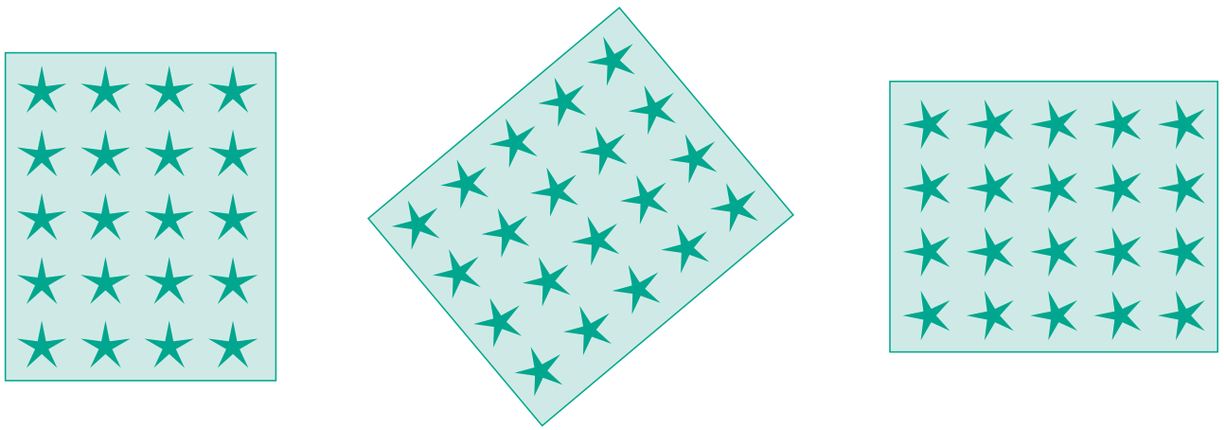


(a) (b) (c)

Fig. 1.2

Now, look at the following example.

$7 - 3 = 4$ but $3 - 7$ will not give the same answer. Similarly, the answers of $12 \div 6$ and $6 \div 12$ are not equal.

That is, $7 - 3 \neq 3 - 7$ and $12 \div 6 \neq 6 \div 12$

Hence, In whole numbers subtraction and division are not commutative.

TRY THESE

- Use atleast three different pairs of whole numbers to verify that subtraction is not commutative.
- Is $10 \div 5$, the same as $5 \div 10$? Justify it by taking two more combinations of numbers.

1.10.2 Associativity of addition and multiplication

When several numbers are added, the order in which the numbers are added does not matter. This is called associativity of addition. Similarly, when several numbers are to be multiplied, the order in which the numbers are multiplied does not matter. This is called associativity of multiplication.

It can be said that the following equations are correct, without actually doing any addition or multiplication, but by using the property of associativity. A few examples are given below:

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